‘independence’, although neither India nor Pakistan is willing to accept the state’s autonomy. For Indians who’ve had enough of the bad news that continues to come from Kashmir, the big question is, ‘Why don’t we settle the issue once and for all, through a war if necessary?’ But as I’ve always emphasised, it is not that simple. The subject has multiple dimensions with a long history of intrigues, and unless leaders from India, Pakistan and Kashmir are all able to make serious compromises and prepare for the resulting political fallout, this matter will continue to fester.

It is thus important for us to understand the story of Kashmir, and how the problem has come to take its current shape. This book has been put together with considerable research, citing sources from the public domain as much as possible to keep things transparent. Whatever the optimists might say, I do not think that the Kashmir issue will be resolved in my lifetime. Though I hope, I am proved wrong!

Maroof Raza